

DNA

(One true God & Deity of the Lord Jesus Christ)
(July 7, 2019 Sermon)

TEXT:

Genesis 1:1-5 (NKJV) *“In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth. ² The earth was without form, and void; and darkness was on the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God was hovering over the face of the waters. ³ Then God said, “Let there be light”; and there was light. ⁴ And God saw the light, that it was good; and God divided the light from the darkness. ⁵ God called the light Day, and the darkness He called Night. So the evening and the morning were the first day.”*

John 1:1-5 (NKJV) *“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ² He was in the beginning with God. ³ All things were made through Him, and without Him nothing was made that was*

made. ⁴ In Him was life, and the life was the light of men. ⁵ And the light shines in the darkness, and the darkness did not comprehend it.”

INTRO:

- Real Vs. Fake...
- Authentic Vs. Counter-fit...

More than \$250 Billion dollars a year of counterfeit products are sold worldwide.

- #9 - CD's and DVD's
- #8 - Labels (trademark logos)
- #7 - Computers and Accessories
- #6 – Footwear
- #5 - Fake medicine
- #4 - Ball caps and jerseys
- #3 – Electronics
- #2 - Watches/Jewelry
- #1 - Handbags and wallets

Counterfeit means an imitation, not real, made to look real - with an intent to deceive. Such products have become known as “Knock Offs”

Counterfeit money has become a real problem. If you don't believe me try using a \$50 dollar bill or a \$100 dollar bill – They use a special marker to determine its authenticity. In fact, U.S. Treasury agents are trained to spot counterfeit money by becoming so familiar with the real thing that the counterfeit becomes immediately obvious to them.

This same principle applies to you and me as saints of God. James 4:8 (TLB) ***“And when you draw close to God, God will draw close to you... and let your hearts be filled with God alone to make them pure and true to Him.”*** Psalm 119:11 (TLB) ***“I have thought much about Your words and stored them in my heart so that they would hold me back from sin.”***

The more time we spend in fellowship with God and in daily reading of His Word, the more and better prepared we will be to not fall for the devil's deceptions, temptations, and schemes!

Satan is not God, and he isn't in the truth business! There isn't anything true about him except that he is a truly dirty devil. Jesus hit the nail right on the head when He said, John 8:44 (NLT & THE MSG) ***“The Devil has always hated the truth. There isn't a shred of truth in him. When he lies (every time he opens his mouth), it is consistent with his character; for he is a liar and the father of lies.”***

Like the counterfeit, “knock off” products I mentioned earlier, Satan is:

- The Great Pretender...
- The want-to-be'er...
- The wish-I-could'er...
- The will-never-be'er...

I. THERE IS ONLY ONE TRUE GOD

The Bible begins with a statement of fact - ***“In the beginning God”***

Interestingly enough, nowhere does the Bible try to prove the existence of God. It begins with a statement of fact - that God exists! Hebrews 11:6 (TLB & The Msg) ***“Anyone who wants to come to God must believe that there is a God, that He exists!”***

Why would Satan or anyone else try to counterfeit something or someone that doesn't exist? The very fact that Satan tries to mimic everything God is and does is proof certain of the existence of God!

Even the Devil knows that God exists! That makes the devil much smarter than many people. Psalm 14:1 & 53:1 ***“The FOOL has said in his heart, ‘There is no God.’”***

Fool (Hebrew):

- Stupid person...
- Ignorant person...

- Arrogant person...
- Morally deficient person...

When the foolish person says that God doesn't exist, it doesn't mean that it's true! They say that because they don't want there to be a God who will interfere in their lives. They believe that if there is no God they can sin all they want, without ever having to give an account for their sins. This is a perfect description of a fool!

Here is the truth... People have made god's out of many things, but there is ONLY ONE true God! Deuteronomy 6:4 (KJV) "***Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God is one LORD:***" Isaiah 45:5 (NKJV) "***I am the LORD, and there is no other; There is no God besides Me. . . .***"

II. THE DEITY OF THE LORD JESUS CHRIST

Mark 8:29 (NKJV) "***He said to them, '... who do you say that I am?' Peter answered and said to Him, 'You are the Christ (the Messiah).'***"

John 1:1 (NLT) ***“In the beginning, the Word already existed. He was with God, and He was God.”***

Jesus is not only God, He is the Son of God!
Luke 22:70 (NIV) ***“They all asked, ‘Are you then the Son of God?’ He replied, ‘You are right in saying I am.’”***

He is not only God and the Son of God, He is the Lord of Glory! Acts 4:33 (NCV - New Century Version) ***“With great power the apostles were telling people that the Lord Jesus was truly raised from the dead”***

He is not only God, the Son of God and the Lord of Glory, He is the First and Last! Isaiah 41:4 (NCV) ***“Who caused this to happen? Who has controlled history since the beginning? I, the LORD, am the one. I was here at the beginning, and I will be here when all things are finished.”*** Revelation 1:17 (NLT) ***“When I***

saw Him, I fell at His (Jesus') feet as dead. But He (Jesus) laid his right hand on me and said, Don't be afraid! I am the First and the Last."

Jesus the divine, is to be worshipped! John 5:23 (NKJV) ***"That all should honor the Son just as they honor the Father. He who does not honor the Son does not honor the Father who sent Him."*** Hebrews 1:6 (NIV) ***". . . when God brings His Firstborn into the world, He says, 'Let all God's angels worship Him.'"*** If angels are commanded to worship Him, we are to also worship Him!

Jesus the divine has life-giving power! John 5:26 (TLB) ***"The Father has life in Himself, and has granted His Son to have life in Himself."*** John 14:6 (NKJV) ***"Jesus said to him, 'I am the way, the truth, and the life. . . .'"***

Jesus was and is the creator! John 1:3 (TLB) ***"He created everything there is — nothing exists that He didn't make."***

Jesus keeps the entire universe functioning. Colossians 1:17 (NLT) ***“He existed before everything else began, and it is His power that holds everything together.”***

Jesus alone has the right to forgive sin. Acts 4:12 (NCV) ***“Jesus is the only One who can save people. His name is the only power in the world that has been given to save people. We must be saved through Him.”***

Jesus is omnipotent! Matthew 28:18 (NLT) ***“Jesus came and told his disciples, ‘I have been given complete (all) authority (power) in heaven and on earth.’”***

Jesus is omniscient! John 16:30 (NLT) ***“Now we understand that You know everything and don’t need anyone to tell You anything. . . .”***

Jesus is omnipresent! Ephesians 1:23 (NLT) ***“Christ fills everything everywhere with His***

Presence.”

CONCLUSION:

Think of His:

- Virgin birth...
- Virtuous life...
- Valid miracles...
- Vicarious death...
- Victorious resurrection...
- Visible ascension...
- Victorious dominion...

III. SANCTIFICATION

I Thessalonians 4:1-7 (NKJV) *“Finally then, brethren, we urge and exhort in the Lord Jesus that you should abound more and more, just as you received from us how you ought to walk and to please God; ² for you know what commandments we gave you through the Lord Jesus. ³ For this is the will of God, your sanctification: that you should abstain from sexual immorality; ⁴ that each of you should know how to possess his own vessel in sanctification and honor, ⁵ not in passion of*

*lust, like the Gentiles who do not know God;
6 that no one should take advantage of and
defraud his brother in this matter, because the
Lord is the avenger of all such, as we also
forewarned you and testified. 7 For God did
not call us to uncleanness, but in holiness.
8 Therefore he who rejects this does not reject
man, but God, who has also given us His Holy
Spirit.”*

Let's listen in as Jesus prays to the Father for His disciples. John 17:14-19 (NKJV) “...*the world has hated them* (The disciples & Christ followers) *because they are not of the world, just as I am not of the world.*¹⁵ *I do not pray that You should take them out of the world, but that You should keep them from the evil one.*¹⁶ *They are not of the world, just as I am not of the world.*¹⁷ *Sanctify them by Your truth. Your word is truth.*¹⁸ *As You sent Me into the world, I also have sent them into the world.*¹⁹ *And for their sakes I sanctify Myself, that they also may be sanctified by the truth.*”

The word “*Sanctify*,” or “*Sanctification*” In our text means to purify or to make Holy. So, our text is preaching a doctrine of sanctification through the blood of Jesus. These passages of Scripture encourage us to:

- Know how to walk...
- Know how to please God...
- Know how to possess our bodies in sanctification and honor...
- Know how to live a holy life as a calling from God...
- Know how to be sanctified by truth... (The Word – “*Thy Word is truth.*”)

Ladies and gentlemen, we are people of the Kingdom! I’m sure you have heard it before, and Jesus say’s as much in the text that I read to you, “*We are in this world, but we are not of this world.*” Exactly what does this mean?

- Does it mean that the reason God saved us was so He could get us to Heaven? Yes and no! Yes, He wants Heaven to be our eternal home, but if that was His only goal, He would have killed us the moment we got saved. He would have put us on His human fishing stringer and taken us to Heaven with Him sooner rather than later.
- Could it mean that He wants us to influence culture here? Yes! We are salt and light! Our Kingdom assignment is to bring a little Heaven to Earth as the result of our presence, and how we choose to live.

What does it look like to bring Heaven to Earth and where does this occur?

- In our home...
- In our church...
- On our job...
- In the marketplace...
- In our neighborhood...

- In our sphere of influence...

Having said this, I must hasten on to say that the only way for us to fulfill our Kingdom assignment of bringing Heaven to Earth is to live an overcoming life. We must live Godly despite the fact that we live in a crooked and perverse culture. The reason we must live this kind of life?

- To bring honor to God... (Walking worthy of the vocation wherewith we have been called)
- To show others there is a better way... (A more excellent way)

Living such a life is only possible through the finished work of the cross and allowing His blood and Word to sanctify us at conversion and then allowing it to do so, each and every day. (Sanctification as a permanent experience Vs. Sanctification as a progressive work.)

Let me give you some definitions of some really religious words:

- Justification is the work God does FOR us...
- Sanctification is the work God does IN us...
- Regeneration is the work God does TO US... (This is the impartation of the new nature)
- Reconciliation is the work God does THROUGH us...

Can I say it this way? Sanctification in the destruction of the old nature and the process of adapting the new nature. This is to be accomplished in order to please God and to have a powerful witness in this world so that everywhere we go we are bringing the culture of Heaven to earth.

Words I think of when I think of sanctification:

- Allegiance...
- Cleansing...
- Consecration...
- Devotion...

- Dedication...
- Faithfulness...
- Fidelity...
- Loyalty...
- Steadfastness...

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (NKJV) “***Now may the God of peace Himself sanctify you completely; and may your whole spirit, soul, and body be preserved blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.***”

Sanctification affects our whole being:

- Body...
- Soul...
- Spirit...
- Actions...
- Deeds...
- Thoughts...
- Words...

According to our text:

- Sanctification is necessary...
- Sanctification is the will of God...
- Sanctification is the path of the righteous...

Without progressive sanctification:

- One cannot achieve holiness... (Without holiness one cannot see the Lord.)
- One cannot have the spirit of Christ...
- One cannot have acceptable worship...
- One cannot bring Heaven to Earth...
- One cannot make Heaven...

CONCLUSION:

What does sanctification look like in the life of the believer?

- Love the things of God...
- Delight in the things of God...
- Hilariously giving of self...
- A desire to bring others to Christ...
- Hatred of sin... (Not a hatred of sinners)

- Preparation for the Second Coming...

In other words, a well-ordered life that pleases God, and brings others to Christ. (Audio visual Christians)

THE CHURCH; ITS MISSION & MINISTRY

TEXT: Amos 3:3 & 7

“Can two walk together, unless they are agreed? (7) Surely the Lord God does nothing, Unless He reveals His secret to His servants the prophets.”

INTRO: God has and is calling us into a partnership with Him so that we can accomplish His revealed kingdom purposes.

If we are in a partnership there are two questions that begged to be asked:

- What are we hoping to accomplish? (We are attempting to bring Heaven to Earth in every sphere. We are also to reach a lost world and then disciple them)
- What are the roles of the partners? (The Lord of the Church furnishes the vision and the power, we are called out to furnish the man power and obedience)

THE CHURCH

Contemporary culture has defined the church as:

- A destination...
- An address...
- A property and building...

This is not at all what the church is. Please know, I believe this is hallowed ground but only because it has been dedicated to the Lord and it is the place where we come together in holy huddles.

The church is the ecclesia. The ecclesia is *“A group of people called out to the purposes of God and who are surrendered to no king but Jesus.”*

The church is the most powerful institution on earth. Jesus asked His disciples who people were saying that He was. Their response?

“Some say you are Elijah, Jeremiah or one of the Prophets.” Jesus turned to them and asked who they believed Him to be? Peter said, *“You are the Christ the Son of the Living God.”*

Jesus said, *Blessed are you Peter, flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, My Father in Heaven revealed this to you.*” He then said, *“Upon this rock I will build My church and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.”*

The church has had many enemies who have written the obituary of the church, but not one of them has been able to pull off the funeral or

burial service. I prophecy, the church will survive:

- Fads...
- Heresy...
- Phonies...
- Charlatans...
- Outright attacks...
- Cultures...
- Systems...
- Governments...
- Nations...
- Demonic leaders...
- Persecution...

I am:

- A fan of the church...
- A champion of the church...
- A defender of the church...
- A protector of the church...

If you have a bad report of the church, don't talk to me. If you don't love the church maybe you need to be reminded that Jesus prophesied it's success and then died to build it

THE MISSION OF THE CHURCH

Mission – definition:

- The business with which a group is charged...
- Any important task or duty that is assigned...
- An important goal or purpose that is accompanied by strong conviction; a calling...

Make no mistake about it, the church has a mission. Nothing is more powerful than getting on mission. (Tower of Babel)

<https://hbr.org/2008/07/unmasking-manly-men>

A 2008 article in Harvard Business review titled, “*Unmasking Manly Men*, ” chronicled the results of an 18-month study of culture and productivity on oil rigs and took a look at a decade-and-a-half of one company’s production.

Offshore oil rigs are a macho environment.

In summary, the findings were that things dramatically improved when the men on those rigs were trained and began to focus on the mission and placing team safety first, rather than proving themselves to be macho (self) ...

“Over the 15-year period these changes in work practices, norms, perceptions, and behaviors were implemented company-wide. The company’s accident rate declined by 84%, while productivity (number of barrels produced), efficiency (cost per barrel), and reliability (production “up” time) increased beyond the industry’s previous benchmark.”

When a group of people, especially the church, become united in vision and mission:

- Efficiency increases...
- Production increases...
- Safety increases...

What is the mission of the church?

- To seek and save that which is lost...
- To be worshipped by man (fellowship)...
- To build a family – We call Him Father...
- To demonstrate His character and attributes...
- To claim a bride for His Son Jesus...
- To disciple the nations...
- To bring Heaven to Earth in every sphere...

Our mission, task, goal, assignment, business, is to partner with God in His kingdom purposes.

Thus, we engage in:

- Evangelism...
- Worship...
- Sonship...
- Holiness...
- Preparing as a bride prepares for her husband...
- Discipleship...
- Creating Kingdom culture...

THE MINISTRY OF THE CHURCH

In order for ministry to be carried out in an effective and Christ honoring fashion, God places leaders over us so that He can give vision to them, and they can give us our marching orders.

Chain of command in the ministry:

- Jesus is the head of the church...

- The pastor is the human authority in the church...
- The pastor doesn't account he deacons the deacons account to the pastor... (The deacons are to implement the vision of the pastor)
- The people submit themselves to the pastor for the purpose of being trained...
- The people carry out the work of the ministry... (Sheep beget sheep)

These leaders are not responsible to do the ministry, they are assigned the responsibility of training God's people to do the ministry.

Ephesians 4:11-15 ***“And He Himself gave some to be apostles {Generals}, some prophets, some evangelists, and some pastors and teachers {Corporals, Sergeants, Captains, Colonels} , 12 for the equipping of the saints for the work of ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ, 13 till we all come to the unity of the faith and***

of the knowledge of the Son of God, to a perfect man, to the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ; 14 that we should no longer be children, tossed to and fro and carried about with every wind of doctrine, by the trickery of men, in the cunning craftiness of deceitful plotting, 15 but, speaking the truth in love, may grow up in all things into Him who is the head—Christ.”

CONCLUSION:

- The church is the best thing afloat...
- The mission of the church will be carried out... (*“I will build my church”* The question is whether or not we will be a part of it)
- The ministry is the most important thing a person can do... (Professional ministry vs. Lay ministry)

